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March 15, 2025

AI Action Plan
Attn: Faisal D'Souza, NCO
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA, 22314

Dear Faisal D'Souza:

The National Committee for Quality Assurance (NCQA) thanks you for the opportunity to provide feedback on the Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD) National Coordination Office (NCO), National Science Foundation AI Action Plan request for information.

NCQA is a private, 501(c)(3) not-for-profit, independent organization dedicated to improving health care quality through our Accreditation and measurement programs. We are a national leader in quality oversight and a pioneer in quality measurement. Leveraging our strengths as a trusted third party, we are committed to helping organizations navigate the challenges associated with transitioning to a digital future. Our mission to improve the quality of health for all Americans propels our daily work.

NCQA is pleased to provide the following comments on AI governance and standards-based AI models for effective outputs in health care in response to the AI Action Plan request for information.

NCQA has been at the forefront of digital enhancements in the health care industry by enabling organizations to move towards digital quality measurement; defining and driving adoption of national digital health data standards; improving data quality for actionable quality initiatives and encouraging health plans and care delivery organizations to adopt practices that accelerate health data exchange. NCQA sees artificial intelligence (AI) as a crucial tool in the advancement of these health care processes. Through our rigorous, expert-based process for developing standards and measures, NCQA is currently **seeking public comment** from industry partners on topics relating to AI that include auditing, monitoring, validation, error handling and incident management, bias mitigation and transparency. As a leader in accreditation and standards innovation, NCQA aims to promote the adoption of AI best practices by health plans and providers.

AI Governance and Accountability

NCQA recognizes the potential for AI technologies to improve health care delivery and augment the work of practitioners and patients seeking to achieve better health outcomes. As these technologies are introduced, AI Governance is essential to ensure AI systems are being applied responsibly and effectively. Organizations should aim to have an effective AI governance structure and process that is accountable for tracking AI use-cases, assessing the risks of AI

systems and monitoring the impact of AI tools on practitioners and patients. Through improved AI governance and accountability, organizations can reduce the risk to patients as AI systems are implemented and monitor for desired AI outputs and quality care delivery. With proper governance, AI systems will lead to efficient care delivery, reduce administrative burden and promote better patient experience at the point of care.

Effective Standards-based AI Models

NCQA's Accreditation programs help health organizations across the nation by meeting standards that ensure their processes meet industry best practices, protect patients and promote better care delivery. AI models should be built based on standards that organizations rely on to enhance current processes, reduce administrative burden and meet the standard for high quality care delivery – without reinventing the workflow. Standards-based AI models allow organizations to be confident in AI model outputs because they are applicable to established processes, produce real-time feedback and improvements and help organizations achieve quality goals. Standards-based AI models will also improve quality measurement workflows by automating processes, improving accuracy and supporting clinician decisions with advance analytics. Through the use of standards-based AI models, organizations will establish the foundation to continuously evolve and adapt their AI systems, streamline current operations and meet emerging health care challenges.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment. We remain committed to working with the NITRD, NCO, the federal government and the Administration to build a more efficient and responsible American health care system. We welcome a discussion on our experience and our recommendations to continue to strengthen government proposals for an AI-enabled future. If you have any questions, please contact me at [REDACTED] or at [REDACTED]

Sincerely,

Eric J. Musser
Vice President, Federal Affairs
National Committee for Quality Assurance